1. Project Overview

1.1 Introduction/Project Vision

- This project is a guided learning tool that can be layered on top of various creative applications (Premiere Pro, Suno, Sora, etc.). It guides users through a creative workflow using text-based step instructions, without interrupting their current work.
- The target users are beginners or people with no prior experience using creative software — those who are unfamiliar with the tools but have a clear creative goal in mind.
- Most existing tutorials for creative tools are text- or video-based, requiring users to constantly switch windows and memorize steps. This project aims to offer a more focused and flexible approach — bringing instructions directly into the creative tool environment, so learning and doing happen in the same place.

1.2 Project Description

- The project is called Aside. It is a desktop app + desktop overlay. Users open Aside on their computer, describe their creative goal (e.g., making a music video), then create a new or select an existing workflow. Aside then appears as a floating overlay on top of the target creative application, with steps that progress as the user works.
- No training is required. The interface is intuitive — users describe what they want to do, and the system automatically generates the steps.
- Users can also create their own workflows, or browse and use workflows shared by others in the community (Discover), which is continuously updated.

2. Project Platform(s)

- The platform is macOS / Windows desktop.
- Aside is not a web app. It is an application installed on the device. It has two main layers: the System Layer (a standalone window app), which users open on their computer to create, manage, and browse workflows; and the Work Layer (the overlay), which appears directly on top of the creative application.
- Users start in the System Layer, enter their goal, and create or select a workflow. When they open a creative tool like Premiere Pro, the Aside overlay appears in the

top-right corner or bottom of the screen, providing step-by-step instructions that advance in real time as they work.

3. Functionality — User flow (example: making a music video using Suno, Sora, and Premiere Pro):

Step 1: Open Aside and go to Home. The homepage shows three entry points:

- Aside Generate (describe what you want to do)
- Import from URL (convert a tutorial link into steps)
- Follow from Discover (choose a ready-made workflow from the community)

Step 2: Aside Generate

- The user describes their goal in text, e.g., "A 60-second cinematic music video, night drive vibe."
- Select tools: Suno for audio, Sora for visuals, Premiere Pro for editing.
- Select level (Beginner / Intermediate / Advanced).

Step 3: Workflow Preview

- The system generates a step-by-step workflow preview.
- The user confirms and clicks Start.

Step 4 — Work Layer

- The user switches to Suno / Sora / Premiere Pro, and the Aside overlay appears, showing the current step instructions.
- Work Layer has three Display Modes and two Appearance Settings (dark and light):
    - Expanded — full overlay showing all information
    - Focus — a slim bar at the top
    - Minimal — a dot + small bar in the bottom-right corner

Step 5: Done

4. Text and Graphic Requirements

4.1 General Look and Feel

- Aside's overall design follows the principles of Low Distraction, Continuous Flow, and Stability, with a style closer to professional creative tools.
- The System Layer uses a white background (#F6F6F8) with generous whitespace — clean and distraction-free. The Work Layer dark mode uses a dark grey background,

mimicking the frosted glass effect of the macOS Dock. The light mode adds soft/diffuse blue and orange glows to avoid a flat appearance.

- Designed for creative users working with macOS and Adobe software.
- The two-layer structure helps users clearly organize their goals and quickly find the right workflow — while not interfering with their active tools during actual use. Aside only assists from the side.

4.2 Basic Content Description

- **Content volume**: Each screen contains very little text. Step instructions are kept to one line; longer explanations and input fields are limited to 1–3 lines. The interface is primarily composed of short text blocks.
- **Content hierarchy**: Divided into two main levels based on layer:
- **System Layer**: page titles / subtitles / descriptions / tags / navigation labels
- **Work Layer**: step title (large) / body text (main instruction) / instruction explanation / error alerts / progress info (STEP 3 OF 5)
- Content is short and displayed in full, but with a Disclosure Indicator that allows expanding or collapsing multi-line content.

4.3 Typographic Requirements

- No special character requirements. No special character sets or multilingual support needed. The interface is entirely in English.
- Accessibility — to meet WCAG AA standards:
- On light backgrounds, text opacity is limited to 2 levels (100% / 60%)
- On dark backgrounds, text color opacity is limited to 2 levels (100% / 80%)
- Small text (9px, 9.5px) uses letter-spacing / uppercase to compensate for legibility.

4.4 Type and Font Selection

All interfaces use three typefaces, all from Google Fonts.

Typeface	Role	Purpose	Selected Reason	Sizes in Use
Nico Moji	**Brand Identity / Logo**	Exclusive to the "Aside" logo; appears in the Top Bar and Panel Headers.	As a **decorative typeface**, its rounded and wide character structure creates an approachable brand personality. Its distinct visual identity ensures high brand recognition.	30px, 26px, 19px

Markazi Text	**Display / Step Titles**	Used exclusively for large headers and workflow titles.	As a **functional typeface**, it clearly distinguishes instruction-based content from standard body text. Its serif style adds a formal tone, providing a strong contrast with Inter to highlight core commands.	30px, 27px, 24px
Inter	**UI & Body Text**	Used for all UI elements and text content except for the logo and display titles.	As an **informational typeface**, it provides an effortless reading experience for long-form content. It maintains high legibility at small scales, making it ideal for dense interface environments.	16px, 15px, 13px, 11px, 9.5px, 9px

Due to the size difference between the System Layer and Work Layer, font examples are shown separately for each layer.

Visual examples shown below:

System Layer:

Logo — Nico Moji, Regular, 30px

Display — Markazi Text, Regular, 30px, Line height 43.9px

H1 — Inter, Semi Bold, 16px

H2 — INTER, SEMI BOLD, 15PX, |A| 1.27PX

H3 — Inter, Semi Bold, 13px, Line height 23

Body1 — Inter, Regular,60%, 15px, Line height 25.5

Body2 — Inter, Regular, 11px, Opacity: 60%

Action/Button(Active) — Inter, Semi Bold, 13px, |A| -0.08px Line height 13

Action/Button(Disabled) — Inter, Regular, 13px, |A| -0.08px Line height 13, Opacity: 60%

Action/Nav1(Utility) — Inter, Semi Bold, 13px

ACTION/NAV2(ACTIVE) — INTER, SEMI BOLD, 9PX, |A| 0.63PX

ACTION/NAV2(DISABLED) — INTER, REGULAR, 9PX, |A| 0.63PX, OPACITY 60%

LABEL1/FILTER(ACTIVE) — INTER, REGULAR, 11PX, |A| 0.94PX, LINE HEIGHT 11

LABEL1/FILTER(DISABLED) — INTER, REGULAR, 11PX, |A| 0.94PX, LINE HEIGHT 11, OPACITY 60%

LABEL2/META(ACTIVE) — REGULAR, 9PX, |A| 2PX

LABEL2/META(DISABLED) — REGULAR, 9PX, |A| 2PX, OPACITY 60%

Work layer:



4.5 Type Style Guide

Aside's typographic system uses font Weight, Size, spacing, capitalization, and opacity to define functional zones. The hierarchy consists of five levels, named T1–T5, ordered by the most visually prominent attributes — Weight and Size. Within the same size, visual depth is created through opacity (100% / 60% / 32%), spacing, and line height to distinguish different interaction states. Details are as follows:

System Layer (Comfort)

Group	Role	Font Family	Size	Weight	Line Height	Letter Spacing	Opacity
Branding	**Logo**	Nico Moji	30px	Regular	43.9px	5.67px	100%
	Display	Markazi Text			43.9px	0	
Heading	**H1**	Inter	16px	Semi Bold	22.4px	0	
	H2		15px		21.0px	1.27px	
	H3		13px		23.0px	0	
Body	**B1 / Main**		15px	Regular	25.5px	0	60%
	B2 / Support		11px		15.4px	0	60%
Action	**Button (Active/Disabled)**		13px	Semi Bold	13.0px	-0.08px	100% /60%

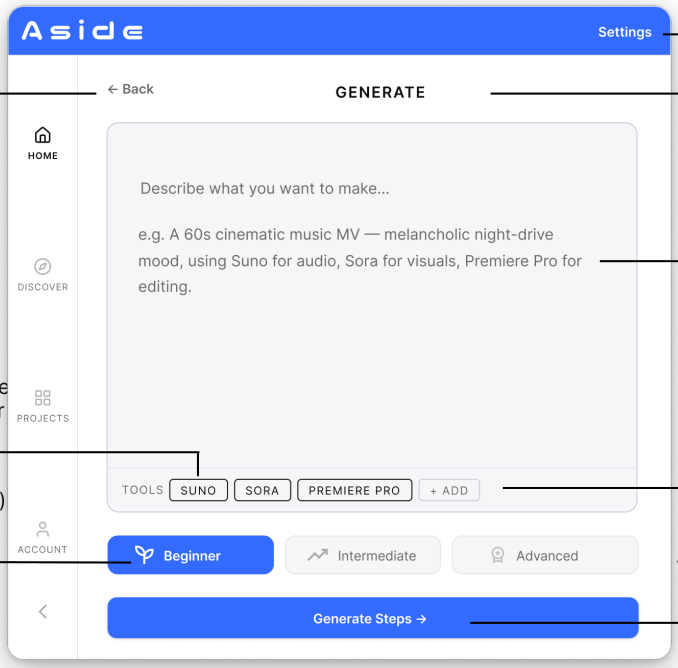
	Nav (Primary)		13px		18.2px	0	100%
	Nav (Secondary)		9px	SB/Reg	12.6px	0.63px	100% / 60%
Label	**Filter (Active/Disabled)**		11px	Regular	11.0px	0.94px	100% / 60%
	Meta (Active/Disabled)		9px		12.6px	2.0px	100% / 60%

Work Layer (Compact)

Group	**Role**	**Font Family**	**Size**	**Weight**	**Line Height**	**Letter Spacing**	**Opacity**
Branding	**Logo (Large)**	Nico Moji	26.5px	Regular	Auto	-	100%
	Logo (Small)		19px		Auto	-	
	Display	Markazi Text	27px		31px	-	
Heading	**H1**	Inter	12px		Auto	1.94px	
Body	**B1 / Primary**		15px		23px	-	
	B1 / Secondary		15px		23px	-	80%
Action	**Button (Active/ Disabled)**		15px	Semi Bold	Auto	-	100%
	Button (Disabled)		15px		Auto	-	80%
	Nav / Link		12px	Regular	Auto	-	100%
Label	**L1 / Active**		9.5px		Auto	0.94px	100%
	L1 / Inactive		9.5px		Auto	0.94px	80%

Visual examples shown below:

Aside Generate



Action/Nav1(Utility):
Inter 13px Semi Bold
Opacity: 60%

Action/Nav1(Utility):
Inter 13px Semi Bold

H2:
Inter 15px Semi Bold
|A| 1.27px

Body1:
Inter 15px Regular 60%
LH 25.5

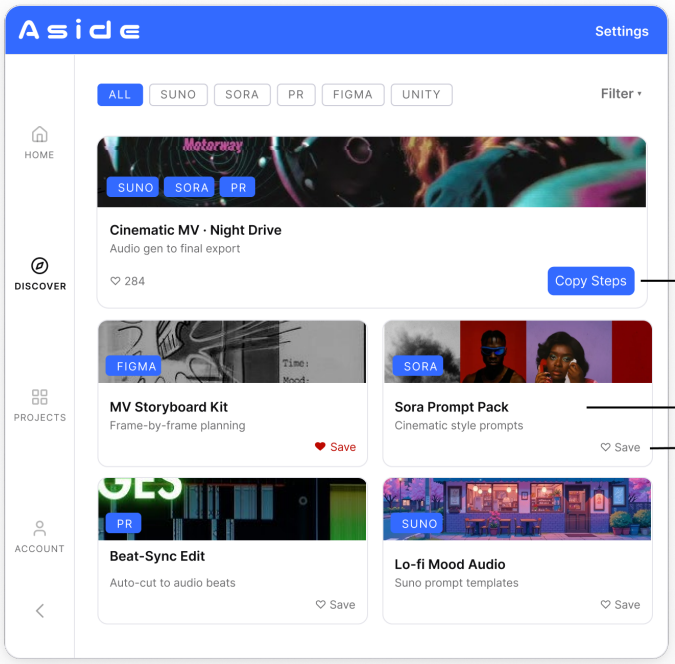
Label/Filter(Active)
Inter 11px Regular
LH 11 |A| 0.94px

Label1/Filter(Disabled):
Inter 11px Regular
LH 11 |A| 0.94px Opacity: 60%

Action/Button(Active)
Inter 13px Semi Bold
|A| -0.08px LH 13

Action/Button(Disabled):
Inter 13px Semi Bold
|A| -0.08px LH 13 Opacity: 60%

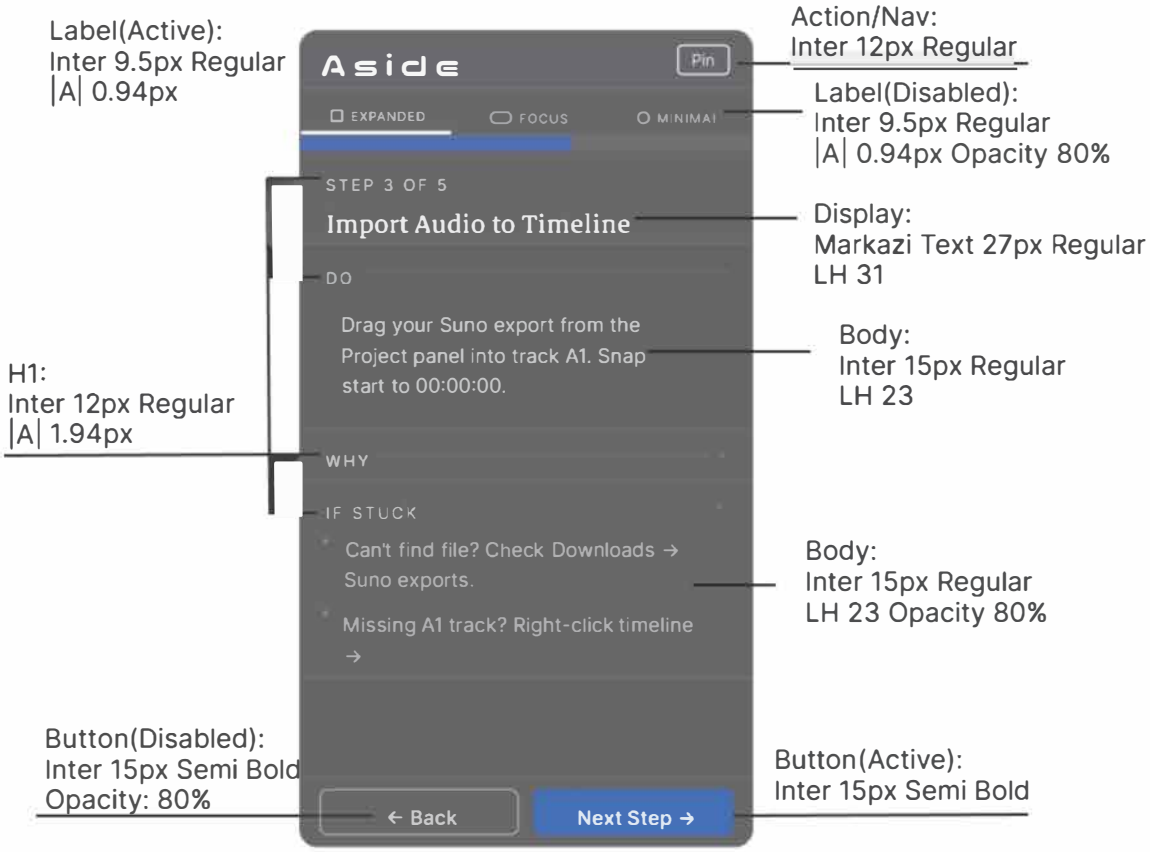
Discover

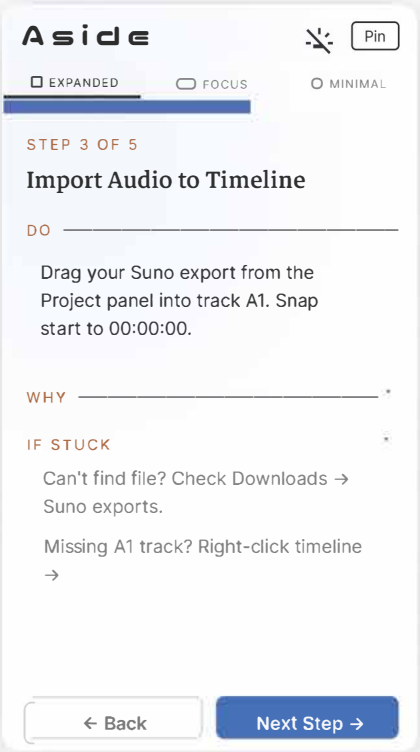


Action/Button:
Inter 13px Semi Bold
|A| -0.08px LH 13

H3:
Inter 13px Semi Bold
LH 23

Body2/Secondary:
Inter 11px Regular
Opacity: 60%









https://www.figma.com/proto/5fghZi38ezu6mdgZ9sEp4g/Aside1.4?node-id=4021-4773&t=rTUuVKf1hSXRgOZi-1

5. Project Summary

Aside is a complete typographic system designed across two interface layers. Both environments use the same content hierarchy and typographic logic — hierarchy is communicated through opacity and weight rather than through visual UI differences. This design stays true to Aside's core principle: low distraction, stability, and long-term guided learning.

The biggest takeaway from this project was the value of continuous testing and iteration. I kept updating my wireframe sketches based on feedback, gradually refining many details — such as adding the System Layer, combining vertical and horizontal layouts, meeting WCAG AA contrast standards, adding color, adjusting opacity, and introducing different sizes and light mode interfaces for responsive design and accessibility. I also found that defining the content first made it much easier to establish the type hierarchy. Once I knew all the content I needed to display, the type system became much clearer and more logical — far more efficient than my previous approach of designing the visual first, then figuring out fonts, sizes, and spacing at the end.

Looking back at the whole process, I realized that having the right medium is essential for showcasing typographic qualities. Since my idea is an app interface — and specifically a guided learning interface — I wasn't able to experiment with highly visual or decorative typefaces. I needed to focus on stable, high-legibility, versatile typefaces like Inter. So throughout the project, my typographic decisions centered on size, opacity, capitalization, and spacing. This also made me realize that typography is a system — changing any single value produces a different visual result.

If I had more time, I would consider exploring variable fonts, especially for type changes triggered by interactions on the page.

References

Note: All icons utilized in the Aside project interface were sourced via the Material Symbols plugin for Figma.

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